

Usability - Semester 2 2025

Usability Design Project (90%)

Overview

Working in a small group, you will design and deliver a prototype of a mobile application that allows a unique group of users to achieve specific tasks.

Through a series of design stages (Submissions 1 to 4), you will complete individual and group tasks to ensure that your project applies principles and theory covered in the unit to improve the user experience of your application.

Project Brief

Mobile applications are used by different types of people to easily complete goals. A well designed application can allow even a novice user to navigate and manage complex information utilising many different features of a modern mobile phone.

People of all ages enjoy playing with different toys or games (including board games and video games) but it can be intimidating for some to buy a new game or toy without being sure they (or their child) will like it, particularly given how expensive some of them are. Conversely, many people also have toys and games that they no longer need, or use very infrequently.

The aim of this project is to design a mobile application that helps users to discover and exchange toys and games. They must be able to request, donate or swap those games/toys with other users. The app will not include any buying or selling features.

Some high level user requirements will need to be covered by the proposed app, which are:

1. Users should be able to find games and toys that match their needs and interests.
2. Users should be able to provide feedback on their swaps with other users.
3. Users should be able to offer games and toys for donation.
4. *<additional requirement proposed by group members>*
5. *<additional requirement proposed by group members>*

Specific implementation of app features will be decided in Submission 2.

Working in a Group

By the end of the week 2 applied class, you should have allocated yourself to a group of 4 members. If any students in an applied class are left without a group, tutors may need to move some people from other groups. You will remain in the same assignment group for the rest of the semester.

The project includes stages that require timely completion of individual and group assessment work. Workload will be scaled to match the number of group members.

Once you have been allocated to a group, you will remain in that group for the rest of the semester. Group members are expected to assume key responsibilities:

- Work in group assessments should be evenly distributed
- Agree on a communication platform for group members to use
- Agree on tools and methods for working collaboratively
- Let your tutor know as soon as possible when a group member fails to meet their responsibilities.

Extensions and Special Consideration

Please be aware that short extensions are not available for group assignments.

Any approved special consideration extensions for a group assessment applies to the entire group. If you have applied for special consideration or an extension has been approved, it is your responsibility to communicate this to your teammates.

Where an extension has been approved, you are still required to communicate and collaborate with your team where practicable. A pending or approved extension is not grounds for not contributing to the assignment or communicating with your teammates.

Peer-review will be used to collect information about individual group member participation. This information will be used to identify potential issues with individual member's contributions. Where necessary, staff may request further evidence such as document version histories to fairly award marks.

Submitting Your Assignments

You are responsible for ensuring your uploaded files are correct and complete before finalising an assignment submission. Staff are not responsible for notifying students of incorrect submissions.

Emails to staff requesting resubmission are typically replied to within 2 working days. Standard late penalties will apply based on the time the resubmission is finalised.

Project Stages

Work for this project will be completed in 4 stages:

- **Submission 1** - Understand Your Users (25%, group and individual, due Friday Week 5)
- **Submission 2** - Low-Fidelity Prototype (25%, individual, due Friday Week 8)
- **Submission 3** - High-Fidelity Prototype and Evaluation (30%, group and individual, due Friday Week 12)
- **Submission 4** - Presentation Video (10%, group and individual, due Week 14)

Assessment briefs and rubrics for each stage will be made available in relevant weeks during the semester.